

Safety Recall - Engine Wiring Harness Chafing Short and Fire Risk

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Area: recalls

1 Defect Description

On affected vehicles, the engine wiring harness assembly HARN-9960 was routed too close to a bracket edge, allowing the insulation to chafe through over time. As the conductors are exposed, an intermittent short to ground sets diagnostic trouble code B1318 and can illuminate multiple warning indicators. Technicians inspecting the harness should follow the Vega Electrical Service Manual :: Network and Harness Sub-System Service procedures, and use the Vega Electrical Service Manual :: CAN Bus Communication Diagnosis Procedure to confirm whether B1318 is caused by the chafed segment. The body-side code reference in the Kestrel Body Service Manual :: Body Diagnostic Trouble Code Reference can help distinguish B1318 from unrelated body faults.

2 Safety Risk

A sustained short circuit through the chafed HARN-9960 conductors can overload the protected circuit and, if the fuse box assembly FUSE-9980 fails to clear the fault promptly, generate enough heat to ignite nearby insulation. This creates a risk of underhood fire whether the vehicle is in motion or parked. Refer to the Vega Electrical Service Manual :: Wiring Harness and Fuse Box section to understand the protection scheme for FUSE-9980. A discharged or unstable system may also present as low voltage, so the Kestrel Body Service Manual :: Low Battery Voltage Diagnosis procedure should be consulted when symptoms overlap.

3 Remedy

Dealers will inspect and replace the engine wiring harness HARN-9960 with a revised assembly that includes additional protective conduit and corrected routing away from the bracket edge. Where evidence of arcing is found, the fuse box assembly FUSE-9980 must also be replaced and the affected circuits re-tested per the Vega Electrical Service Manual :: Wiring Diagrams and Reference . After repair, verify that B1318 does not reset by re-running the diagnostic in the Vega Electrical Service Manual :: Electrical System Overview . This recall remedy is performed free of charge; see <https://www.nhtsa.gov/recalls> for owner notification details.